

DANCE

OVERVIEW

Dance at the Grade 9 and 10 level introduces students to the notions that movement is a medium of expression and that the human body is an instrument. Dance transforms images, ideas, and feelings into movement sequences. Learning in dance requires a balance of knowledge, skills, and attitudes, and embraces movement, creation, and performance. Appreciation of dance expands students' awareness of the richness of various cultures around the world. The study and practice of composition provide students with the essential building blocks that support lifelong interest in, appreciation of, and curiosity about dance.

Students develop their kinesthetic awareness and use the elements of dance (body, space, time, energy, and relationship) to compose dance creations. Students also develop dance technique, which emphasizes physiological and safety factors while allowing them to enhance their ability to use the body and all its parts for creative expression.

The art of dance should be shared. Through informal presentations and more formal performances, students use dance to communicate their aesthetic and personal values. By experiencing, analysing, and commenting on the performances of others, students enhance their understanding of the values of other dance artists and cultures.

Students learn about the dynamic relationship between process and product through creating their own choreography and interpreting existing dance works. They also develop their understanding of the role of dance in various cultures, societies, and historical periods.

The expectations for courses in dance are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 14–16) to create, re-create, and present dance composition in a variety of contexts. The effective use of this process requires a nurturing environment that encourages students to explore their ideas freely and without inhibition. Creative work in dance involves the realization of exercises, explorations, experiments, dance works, and productions through the development of students' abilities, skills, and competencies.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** The critical analysis process (see pages 16–20) at this level promotes rational and logical thinking for learning in, about, and through dance. Students respond to, analyse, reflect on, and evaluate dance performances; explore and research the forms and functions of dance; and begin to understand dance as a universal language.

3. **Foundations:** This strand encompasses the body of knowledge, concepts, conventions, and norms that create an underpinning and a context for dance as an arts discipline. Learning how to move the human body and expanding its movement vocabulary help students understand how and why people dance. This strand emphasizes the importance of health and safety, historical and cultural context, dance vocabulary, and a variety of protocols related to ethics and etiquette.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 11–12 of this document.

The list of approved focus courses for Dance can be found at:

www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Dance, Grade 9

Open

ATC10

This course gives students the opportunity to explore their technical and compositional skills by applying the elements of dance and the tools of composition in a variety of performance situations. Students will generate movement through structured and unstructured improvisation, demonstrate an understanding of safe practices with regard to themselves and others in the dance environment, and identify the function and significance of dance within the global community.

Prerequisite: None

A. CREATING, PRESENTING, AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process, the elements of dance, and a variety of sources to develop movement vocabulary;
- A2. Choreography and Composition:** combine the elements of dance in a variety of ways in composing individual and ensemble dance creations;
- A3. Dance Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of the dance techniques and movement vocabularies of a variety of dance forms from around the world;
- A4. Performance:** apply dance presentation skills in a variety of contexts and performances.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use the elements of dance to develop and perform a personal movement vocabulary inspired by a variety of stimuli, sources, or themes (*e.g., choose five gestures used in everyday life and create a sixteen-bar movement phrase that reflects and exaggerates these gestures; with a partner, generate original movement material based on a personally meaningful source or theme*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some possible movements you can use to illustrate the ideas and feelings suggested by your artistic source?”

- A1.2** create and perform phrases that explore two or more elements of dance (*e.g., use contrasting shapes such as geometric versus organic while varying the levels; revisit phrases they have created and explore places within the phrases where they can alter their body base*)

Teacher prompt: “What are the challenges of passing from one movement to the next when changing your body base? What strategies do you use to maintain a smooth flow of movement?”

- A1.3** use the elements of dance to generate and perform movement vocabulary through guided improvisation (*e.g., in response to a variety of musical stimuli, allow the body to move in an organic, unrehearsed way while keeping the eyes*

closed; mirror a partner by standing face to face and moving slowly to copy the exact gestures or actions of the person who is leading)

Teacher prompt: “What is the biggest challenge of working spontaneously? Why is it helpful to have the improvisation guided or structured? How will improvising in and around other dancers affect your spontaneous movement?”

- A1.4** develop solutions to movement problems using specific guidelines for performance (*e.g., present a new perspective on familiar material by taking an eight-count phrase taught in dance technique class and performing it in reverse [retrograde]*)

Teacher prompt: “How will you make sure you accurately reproduce the movements that make up this phrase when performing it in a different format?”

A2. Choreography and Composition

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** demonstrate an understanding of choreographic forms, structures, and techniques in arranging and performing a series of movement phrases (*e.g., combine phrases from class to create an ensemble composition; arrange phrases to be performed as a canon*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some other ways of arranging these phrases to create visual interest and explore the possibilities of other forms?”

A2.2 construct a short dance composition based on a given stimulus (e.g., *explore creative ways to use a prop [such as a ball, body bag, large piece of fabric, hockey bag, or stick] as the stimulus and starting point for a short dance composition; use a process or form observed in nature as the basis for a short dance composition; create a short dance based on images from nature in Aboriginal art*)

Teacher prompt: “If your prop is meant to be a symbol for something in your dance, how can you structure your dance to clarify the meaning of your prop?”

A2.3 use experimentation to enhance the communicative power of their dance compositions (e.g., *create short dance compositions on the same theme both with and without the use of a defined structure, recipe, or stimulus, and assess the expressive potential of each approach*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the benefits and the challenges of using and not using a given structure, recipe, or stimulus to create a dance composition? In which instance is the movement material more interesting, and why?” “What are some familiar movements we associate with different animals? How might you experiment with other types of movements for communicating new or different ideas about the animals?”

A3. Dance Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 apply an understanding of the movement vocabularies used in a variety of dance forms from around the world (e.g., *explore and practise the basic movements found in dance forms under the umbrella term “jazz”, including African dance, swing dance, Luigi jazz, and hip hop or break-dancing*)

Teacher prompt: “How are jazz dance characteristics such as syncopation, individual style, and improvisation reflected in African dance? How might you integrate them into a dance sequence you are creating?”

A3.2 demonstrate accurate memorization and reproduction of dance sequences from verbal, visual, and/or auditory cues (e.g., *demonstrate accurately and in the correct order the components of a plié exercise that has been modelled for them; repeat the exercise, making any necessary self-corrections*)

Teacher prompts: “How does observing correct and incorrect models help you self-correct your technique? What other visual cues do you use to help you reproduce movement?” “When learning movement, do you watch the whole body moving when the teacher is demonstrating or do you focus on one body part at a time?”

A3.3 arrange and present a sequence using the dance vocabulary and technique from a specific dance form (e.g., *in small groups, rearrange and perform a jazz combination*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some of the challenges you think you might face when pulling apart a known phrase and re-sequencing it?”

A4. Performance

By the end of this course, students will:

A4.1 revise and refine movement to enhance dance presentations and performances (e.g., *revisit choreography or dance phrases they created and apply teacher and peer feedback to their next work*)

Teacher prompt: “What is the value of getting feedback from both the teacher and your peers? Do you feel it improves your dance execution? Why, and in what way?”

A4.2 apply an understanding of stagecraft in the presentation and performance process (e.g., *explore the function of lighting, sound/music, costume, and setting in dance; research the clothing worn in the 1930s to inform their costume choices for a swing dance piece*)

Teacher prompt: “What factors affect your decisions about the costumes, stage settings, and other supports you need for a performance?”

A4.3 apply an understanding of techniques for projecting moods to enhance meaning in dance rehearsals and performances (e.g., *use the eyes, facial expression, and direction of gaze to support and enhance the message of the dance*)

Teacher prompt: “What message is conveyed by a lowered gaze during a performance? What message is conveyed by an alert, focused expression? Which message would be more appropriate to this particular performance?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' dance works and activities;
- B2. Dance and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used dance, and of how creating and viewing dance can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and possibilities of continuing engagement in dance arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** use the critical analysis process to identify and describe a variety of dance forms (e.g., *identify and describe key characteristics found in each dance form experienced in the Grade 9 dance program*)

Teacher prompt: "When watching dance on television, what do you look for to help you identify the dance form?"

- B1.2** explain the difference between the content of dance and the expressive, interpretive aspects, and assess the contribution of each (e.g., *assess a particular dance performance in terms of the types of movements included and how well they communicate ideas and feelings; express and support an opinion about the relative importance of content and expression in achieving a successful dance performance*)

Teacher prompt: "How can technical skill and expressiveness work together to create an outstanding performance? Can you have one without the other? Have you ever seen or performed a dance that was lacking in one of those areas? What could you do to correct the imbalance?"

B2. Dance and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** identify and describe the characteristics and function of a social dance within a society (e.g., *baroque dance of the court of King Louis XIV of France*)

Teacher prompt: "What social dances exist in society today? What social dance do you take part in, and how is that dance a reflection of the society in which you live?"

- B2.2** explain how dance exploration can contribute to personal growth and self-understanding (e.g., *identify feelings they experience while dancing that contribute to their sense of well-being or self-worth*)

Teacher prompt: "What have you learned about yourself through dance? Could you learn those things through other activities? Why or why not?"

- B2.3** demonstrate an understanding of how different types of dance reflect aspects of the culture that produced them (e.g., *the sailor's hornpipe in nineteenth-century England evolved from a dance done on the wet deck of a ship*)

Teacher prompt: "What was the purpose of the sailor's hornpipe and how did it reflect social conditions in nineteenth-century England?"

B2.4 explain how dance can contribute to a sense of community (*e.g., a dance performance can help draw attention to or raise funds for a social or environmental cause in the school or local community*)

Teacher prompt: “The school is having an assembly to celebrate Earth Day. What could our dance class do to help highlight the significance of this event?”

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 identify knowledge, skills, and personal qualities/attitudes they have acquired or strengthened through dance studies that can be applied in other settings and to a variety of careers (*e.g., personal qualities such as willingness to take risks, discipline, cooperativeness, empathy, willingness to take responsibility*)

Teacher prompt: “Is the behaviour expected of you in dance class the same as or different from your usual behaviour outside of class? What situations outside dance class might have behavioural expectations similar to those in the class?”

B3.2 identify and describe ways in which dance plays a role in their community (*e.g., identify local dance schools and organizations and outline their similarities and differences*)

Teacher prompt: “What are the main characteristics that the dance studios and organizations in our community have in common? What part(s) of the community do these dance organizations serve? Are any part(s) of the community left out?”

B3.3 develop a portfolio that records their dance-related learning in a variety of ways (*e.g., in handouts, written work, and project descriptions, in either a digital or a traditional format*), and use it to analyse their strengths and areas that need improvement

Teacher prompt: “What does your portfolio reveal about your areas of strength in performing and understanding dance as an art form? What does it tell you about areas where you need to improve?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Physiology and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, the physiology of movement as it relates to dance;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the social, cultural, and historical origins and development of dance forms, including their influence on each other and on society;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in dance activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Physiology and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the importance of a positive body image and a healthy lifestyle to their learning in dance (*e.g., identify a skill or a quality they possess that contributes to their learning and achievement in dance and create a collage to celebrate that aspect*)

Teacher prompt: “Was it difficult to find a personal quality to celebrate? Is it easier to focus on the negative or the positive aspects of our lives? What might be the benefits of focusing on the positive aspects?”

- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of the nature and function of the skeletal system in relation to the physiology of movement (*e.g., create a physical representation of the axial and the appendicular skeleton*)

Teacher prompt: “What are the challenges you faced when trying to place the bones correctly on the body figure handout?”

- C1.3** demonstrate, and describe using correct terminology, the movement repertoire of a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., define and demonstrate movements associated with jazz dance, such as “rock step”, “isolation”, “hip walk”, “flat back”, “jazz run”, “pivot turn”, “cat walk”; create a dance sequence to illustrate five movement terms*)

Teacher prompt: “What memorization techniques can you use to help remember dance terminology?”

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of the origins and development of a given dance form (*e.g., trace how elements of African drumming and dancing were combined with techniques of European clog and step dancing to become American tap dance in the 1920s; create a timeline highlighting key personalities and events in the evolution of ballet*)

Teacher prompts: “How might you describe the relationships among the innovators of jazz dance in the twentieth century? How can you visually depict the connections among them?” “What contributions to dance were made by the key figures in your timeline? What were some obstacles these people had to overcome in their careers?”

- C2.2** identify and describe ways in which choreographers and performers use or have used dance to address social and environmental issues (*e.g., identify issues raised in Danny Grossman’s 1981 work Endangered Species and discuss their relevance to society today; describe how Isabel Croxatto’s Revolution of the Butterflies highlights the urgent need to protect and restore the environment*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the social justice issues that are revealed in Grossman’s choreography? Are any of those issues currently relevant?” “How are the elements of dance used in *Revolution of the Butterflies* to help convey its message?”

C2.3 identify some shared characteristics of dance forms from around the world and illustrate them through performance (e.g., describe similarities in two or more of hip hop, Afro-Caribbean, folk, and ballroom dance, and identify cultural factors that influenced the development of each form; identify elements in the Aboriginal dances of two different cultures that reveal their connection to nature and the environment)

Teacher prompts: “What are some similarities in the foot patterns of breakdance and capoeira?” “How are dances of Polynesians and Aboriginal peoples in Canada the same and/or different in the way they reflect the natural environment?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify and follow responsible practices in dance activities (e.g., identify which dance positions and movements are most/least compatible with their level of fitness and/or body type, and establish realizable personal goals for training and performance)

Teacher prompt: “How can we ensure that we are listening to our bodies while we dance? How can we respect our bodies while still striving to improve our dance skills? How can we respect ourselves while still trying to improve coordination and flexibility?”

C3.2 demonstrate collaborative skills during the rehearsal and performance processes (e.g., listen and respond respectfully to others in rehearsals)

Teacher prompts: “What do you find most challenging when working with others on a performance task?” “What could you do to improve communication with your peers during collaborative dance activities?”

C3.3 identify and follow safe and ethical practices in dance activities (e.g., establish a code of conduct and a list of health and safety guidelines for the dance studio; create a web diagram outlining the key character traits necessary to maintain a safe and healthy environment in the dance class; respect copyright laws; develop a class definition of ethical practices in dance; acknowledge all sources and contributions from others; build on the ideas of others without directly copying from them)

Teacher prompts: “What are some safety concerns that we need to address in our dance studio?” “How does showing respect for the feelings and opinions of others contribute to a safe environment?” “How is it possible to ‘borrow’ an idea and make it your own without directly copying or plagiarizing?”